

OnePlus Nord 5

Playing safe no more

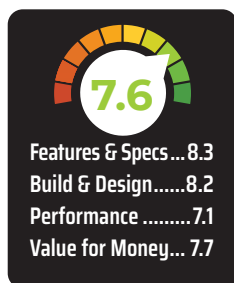
The OnePlus Nord 5 doesn't feel like a Nord anymore. That's not a criticism, it's a wake-up call to every other phone in the mid-range segment. This is the first Nord device to pack a Snapdragon 8-series chipset, a 144Hz OLED panel, and a camera system that borrows heavily from OnePlus' flagships. While last year's Nord 4 charmed us with its metal design, the Nord 5 feels like OnePlus turning a page, leaning harder into performance, AI, and competitive gaming than it ever has in this series. With a revamped design language, more ambitious hardware, and a price that still stays comfortably below premium flagships, the Nord 5 tries to do it all. But does it manage to keep its promise without over-reaching? Let's find out.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Nord 5 dials back the nostalgia of the Nord 4's all-metal unibody and trades it in for something sleeker, more refined, and a touch more premium-feeling. At just 8.1mm thin, with flat edges and barely-there 1.65mm bezels around the display, the Nord 5 looks and feels like it belongs in a higher price bracket.

Gone is the iconic alert slider, once a signature OnePlus flourish. In its place is the new "Plus Key", a tactile button on the left side of the frame. While it lacks the muscle memory charm of the physical slider, this addition signals OnePlus' evolving priorities: the Plus Key acts as a dedicated gateway to AI features like Plus Mind.

Structurally, the phone feels solid in hand, with tight tolerances and a pleasing weight distribution. There's also IP65 water and dust resistance, which adds peace of mind for daily use. The button placement is ergonomic,



and while the smooth finish might feel slippery to some, it's hard to deny the design's overall sophistication. It may not have the raw nostalgia of the Nord 4's metal build, but it definitely looks and feels like a high-end phone.

DISPLAY

The OnePlus Nord 5 might just have the best display in its price range. It has a 6.83-inch 1.5K OLED panel with a smooth 144Hz refresh rate, but beyond the numbers, it's refinement stands out. Whether you're scrolling, gaming, or watching content, this panel handles motion, colour, and contrast with poise.

In Calman testing using a colourimeter, the Nord 5's Natural profile delivered an average deltaE of just 0.5 and a maximum deltaE of 1.9, which is frankly phenomenal. For context: a deltaE of under 1 is considered indistinguishable to the human eye. This means the reds you see while editing Instagram Stories, the blues in your YouTube thumbnails, or the greens in that recipe reel are actually true to life. You're seeing content closer to what the creator intended.

The touch response is on point, rated at 3000Hz, making the display feel faster and responsive whether you're in the middle of a heated battle in BGMI or scrolling through Instagram. And if you're caught in the rain, Aqua Touch 2.0 ensures the screen still responds accurately even with wet or sweaty fingers.

Ultimately, this isn't just a "good for the price" panel; it's good, period. Whether you're a gamer, a Netflix binger, or someone who just wants their wallpaper to look exactly how it should, the Nord 5's display will deliver.

PERFORMANCE

The Nord 5 marks a significant performance leap over its predecessor, thanks to the Snapdragon 8s Gen 3. While not the absolute top-of-the-line chip in its class (the Poco F7 edges it out with the newer 8s Gen 4), the Nord 5 still delivers flagship-grade performance, especially when compared to last year's Snapdragon 7+ Gen 3 in the Nord 4.

These results place the Nord 5 above the Nord 4 across every performance metric: CPU, GPU, stability, and sustained output. However, the Poco F7 remains the top dog in this segment, particularly in raw benchmarks.

Benchmark	Nord 5	Nord 4	Poco F7
AnTuTu	1,476,520	1,178,370	2,083,452
Geekbench (SC/MC)	1952 / 4890	1166 / 4077	1981 / 6001
CPU Throttle Test	84%	77%	90%
PCMark Work 3.0	18,732	11,278	16,953
3DMark Wild Life Extreme	3134	3076	3811